CS SE The Consortium of Selective Schools in Essex

TEST 1

ENGLISH

Name: _____

Candidate Number: _____

Primary School: _____

Boy or Girl: _____

Date of Birth: _____

Today's Date: _____

Test Taken At: _____

READ THE FOLLOWING CAREFULLY:

1. **Do not open this booklet until you are told to do so.**
2. Inside this booklet is an English passage on a separate sheet. Read the passage carefully when you are told to do so and then answer the questions in the booklet.
3. Think carefully about the passage and its meaning.
4. **Work quickly but carefully through the questions.**
5. The number of marks available for each question is indicated in the right hand margin.
6. Incorrect spelling will be penalised.
7. Punctuation should be both clear and exact.
8. Where you are asked to choose between a number of possible responses choose always the **MOST APPROPRIATE** response.
9. If you finish with time to spare please remember to check your work.
10. You will have **40 minutes** to do the test.
11. **Once the test has begun, you should not ask about questions in the test.**

NOT TO BE FILLED IN BY PUPIL		
PAGE	SCORE	
	R	W
1 (10) 2 (21) 3 (19)		
TOTAL (50)		
INITIALS OF MARKER(S)		

REMEMBER, this is not a test of memory. You can look back at the passage to check your answers as many times as you want.

2007 ENTRY CS SE

All rights reserved, including translation. No part of this publication may be reproduced or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or mechanical, including photocopying, recording or duplication in any information storage and retrieval system, without permission in writing from CSSE, and may not be photocopied or otherwise reproduced with the terms of any licence granted by the Copyright Licensing Agency Ltd.

Copyright © The Consortium of Selective Schools in Essex, 2006.

It is the threshing of the last wheat-rick at Flintcomb-Ash Farm. The dawn of the March morning is singularly inexpressive, and there is nothing to show where the eastern horizon lies. Against the twilight rises the trapezoidal top of the stack, which has stood forlornly here through the washing and bleaching of the wintry weather.

When Izz Huett and Tess arrived at the scene of operations only a rustling denoted that others had preceded them; to which, as the light increased, there were presently added the silhouettes of two men on the summit. They were busily 'unhaling' the rick, that is, stripping off the thatch before beginning to throw down the sheaves; and while this was in progress Izz and Tess, with the other women-workers, in their whitey-brown pinafores, stood waiting and shivering, Farmer Groby having insisted upon their being on the spot thus early to get the job over if possible by the end of the day. Close under the eaves of the stack, and as yet barely visible, was the red tyrant that the women had come to serve – a timber-framed construction, with straps and wheels appertaining – the threshing-machine which, whilst it was going, kept up a despotic demand upon the endurance of their muscles and nerves.

A little way off there was another indistinct figure; this one black, with a sustained hiss that spoke of strength very much in reserve. The long chimney running up beside an ash-tree, and the warmth which radiated from the spot, explained without the necessity of much daylight that here was the engine which was to act as the *primum mobile* of this little world. By the engine stood a dark motionless being, a sooty and grimy embodiment of tallness, in a sort of trance, with a heap of coals by his side: it was the engineman. The isolation of his manner and colour lent him the appearance of a creature from Hell, who had strayed into the pellucid smokelessness of this region of yellow grain and pale soil, with which he had nothing in common, to amaze and to discompose its inhabitants.

What he looked he felt. He was in the agricultural world, but not of it. He served fire and smoke; these denizens of the fields served vegetable, weather, frost, and sun. He travelled with his engine from farm to farm, from county to county, for as yet the steam threshing-machine was itinerant in this part of Wessex. He spoke in a strange northern accent; his thoughts being turned inwards upon himself, his eye on his iron charge, hardly perceiving the scenes around him, and caring for them not at all: holding only strictly necessary intercourse with the natives, as if some ancient doom compelled him to wander here against his will. The long strap which ran from the driving-wheel of his engine to the red thresher under the rick was the sole tie-line between agriculture and him.

While they uncovered the sheaves he stood apathetic beside his portable repository of force, round whose hot blackness the morning air quivered. He had nothing to do with the preparatory labour. His fire was waiting incandescent, his steam was at high pressure, in a few seconds he could make the long strap move at an invisible velocity. Beyond its extent the environment might be corn, straw, or chaos; it was all the same to him. If anyone asked him what he called himself, he replied shortly, 'an engineer'.

The rick was unhaled by full daylight; the men then took their places, the women mounted, and the work began. Farmer Groby had arrived ere this, and by his orders Tess was placed on the platform of the machine, close to the man who fed it, her business being to untie every sheaf of corn handed on to her by Izz Huett, who stood next, but on the rick; so that the feeder could seize it and spread it over the revolving drum, which whisked out every grain in one moment.

They were soon in full progress, after a preparatory hitch or two, which rejoiced the hearts of those who hated machinery. The work sped on till breakfast-time, when the thresher was stopped for half an hour; and on starting again after the meal the whole supplementary strength of the farm was thrown into the labour of constructing the straw-rick, which began to grow beside the stack of corn. A hasty lunch was eaten as they stood, without leaving their positions, and then another couple of hours brought them near to dinner-time; the inexorable wheels continuing to spin, and the penetrating hum of the thresher to thrill to the very marrow all who were near the revolving wire-cage.

The old men on the rising straw-rick talked of the past days when they had been accustomed to thresh with flails on the oaken barn-floor; when everything was effected by hand-labour, which, to their thinking, though slow, produced better results. Those, too, on the corn-rick talked a little; but the perspiring ones at the machine, including Tess, could not lighten their duties by the exchange of many words. It was the ceaselessness of the work which tried her so severely, and began to make her wish that she had never come to Flintcomb-Ash. The women on the corn-rick could stop to drink ale or cold tea from the flagon now and then, or to exchange a few gossiping remarks while they wiped their faces or cleared the fragments of straw and husk from their clothing; but for Tess there was no respite; for, as the drum never stopped, the man who fed it could not stop, and she, who had to supply the man with untied sheaves, could not stop either.

Please do not write in this space

1. Why is the dawn singularly inexpressive?
(Tick **two** boxes)

2 marks

- **A.** It is a dark autumn day. ☐
- **B.** The sun does not lighten the sky as it rises. ☐
- **C.** It is raining and so the sun cannot be seen. ☐
- **D.** The sunlight is blocked out by the stack. ☐
- **E.** The sky is uniformly dark although it is morning. ☐
- **F.** There is a dim evening twilight. ☐

2. Which of the following are true of Izz Huett's and Tess's arrival?
(Tick **three** boxes)

3 marks

- **A.** They are the first to arrive. ☐
- **B.** They arrive in daylight. ☐
- **C.** They hear noises made by other arrivals. ☐
- **D.** They are late. ☐
- **E.** Farmer Groby is the 'tyrant' they have come to serve. ☐
- **F.** They are cold. ☐
- **G.** Two men have arrived before them. ☐

3. The threshing machine runs on:
(Tick **one** box)

1 mark

- **A.** electricity ☐
- **B.** water ☐
- **C.** steam ☐
- **D.** wheels ☐
- **E.** manpower ☐
- **F.** internal combustion ☐

4. The person who manages the machines has certain features in common with his engine: (Tick **three** boxes)

3 marks

- **A.** Both are strong. ☐
- **B.** Both are tall. ☐
- **C.** Both are ugly. ☐
- **D.** Neither is moving. ☐
- **E.** Both are local. ☐
- **F.** Both are dark, discoloured figures. ☐

5. How are the engine and the threshing machine linked? (Tick **one** box)

1 mark

- **A.** By means of timber. ☐
- **B.** By a strap. ☐
- **C.** By means of wheels. ☐
- **D.** Through "unhaling" the rick. ☐

R
W
(10)

Please do not write in this space

6. What was the reason that the wheat-rick had been thatched? (Tick **one** box) — 1 mark

- **A.** To make it look tidy. ☐
- **B.** To protect the stored crop of corn over the winter. ☐
- **C.** To please Farmer Groby. ☐
- **D.** To provide work for the thatchers. ☐
- **E.** To provide work for the men "unhaling" the rick. ☐

7. The engineer does not seem to fit into his present surroundings. Which of the following make him different? (Write **TRUE** or **FALSE** in the spaces provided.) — 7 marks

- **A.** He has little direct link to agriculture. .....
- **B.** He is better educated than the other workers. .....
- **C.** He does not wish to be at Flintcomb-Ash Farm. .....
- **D.** He has no fixed place of work. .....
- **E.** He deliberately makes work hard for Tess and Izz. .....
- **F.** He comes from a different part of the country from the other workers. .....
- **G.** The other workers seem busy, he seems to do little. .....

8. Select from the passage **one word** which most closely corresponds to the word or phrase on the left. Guidance is given in the right hand column below on the lines within which the word may be found. Even if you do not know the word, you may be able to work out what it means from the context. — 12 marks

	Word from passage	Look in lines
A. indicated	.....	1 - 8
B. outline figures	.....	3 - 11
C. tyrannical	.....	9 - 16
D. staying power	.....	10 - 18
E. hypnotic state	.....	12 - 21
F. travelling from place to place	.....	24 - 32
G. storage place	.....	30 - 38
H. glowing with heat	.....	30 - 38
I. speed	.....	33 - 40
J. relentless	.....	44 - 51
K. extremely	.....	53 - 61
L. temporary relief	.....	53 - 61

9. As the corn rick (or stack) is reduced in size, another rick is constructed from the material that is a left-over of the process of threshing. What is this material? (Write **one** word in the box.) — 1 mark

R
W
(21)

PLEASE TURN OVER TO NEXT PAGE

10. Which of the following are true of the threshing process? (Write **TRUE** or **FALSE** in the spaces.)

6 marks

A. Three people are involved in getting the corn into the threshing machine. .....

B. All those involved in getting the corn into the threshing machine stand on the machine. .....

C. All those involved in getting the corn into the threshing machine stand on the corn-rick. .....

D. All those involved in getting the corn into the threshing machine are women. .....

E. Tess's job is to feed the corn into the machine. .....

F. The corn on the corn-rick is fastened into bundles. .....

11. *(part i)* Which of the following have to work the hardest? (Tick **one** box)

1 mark

A. The men on the straw-rick. ☐

B. The workers on the corn-rick. ☐

C. Those on the threshing machine. ☐

11. *(part ii)* Give three pieces of evidence which suggest that this is the case. **(Write complete sentences.)**

6 marks

A. .....

.....

B. .....

.....

C. .....

.....

12. Copy out the section below, inserting correct punctuation and capital letters where necessary.

6 marks

Tess murmured i am so tired
You can rest soon said Izz when the machine stops.

.....

.....

.....

.....

END OF TEST
(You should have completed 12 questions.)

Please do not write in this space

R
W
(19)

Copyright © The Consortium of Selective Schools in Essex, 2006.

MARKING SCHEME - CSSE ENGLISH TEST FOR ENTRY IN SEPTEMBER 2007

Candidates must not tick more boxes than they are instructed to. Any who do will lose all the marks for that question.

Question	Answer	Marks
1	B, E	2 marks
2	C, F, G	3 marks
3	C	1 mark
4	B, D, F	3 marks
5	B	1 mark
6	B	1 mark
7A	true	
7B	false	
7C	false	
7D	true	
7E	false	
7F	true	
7G	true	7 Marks
8A	denoted	
8B	silhouettes	
8C	despotic	
8D	endurance	
8E	trance	
8F	itinerant	
8G	repository	
8H	incandescent	
8I	velocity	
8J	inexorable	
8K	severely	
8L	respite	12 marks
9	straw	1 mark
10A	true	
10B	false	
10C	false	
10D	false	
10E	false	
10F	true	6 marks
11(i)	C	1 mark
11(ii) A	The ones on the machine perspire. (2 marks)	
11(ii) B	The ones on the machine talk the least. (2 marks)	
11(ii) C	The ones on the machine have to work at the speed/pace of the machine which does not stop or pause. (2 marks)	
	The ones on the machine could not take a drink or have a rest. (2 marks). *1 mark for content, 1 for sentence. Candidate must have 3 correct pieces of evidence out of the four possible answers to gain the total of 6 marks*	6 marks
12	Open and close inverted commas around "I am so tired" (1 mark)	
	Open and close inverted commas around "You can rest soon," (1 mark)	
	comma after "soon" inside inverted commas (1 mark)	
	comma after "Izz" before open inverted commas (1 mark)	
	open and close inverted commas around "when the machine stops." (1 mark)	
	comma after murmured, full stop after tired (1 mark for both correct)	
	Tess murmured, "I am so tired." "You can rest soon," said Izz, "when the machine stops."	6 marks
		TOTAL 50